Padua nearly pulls shocker over Panthers

Elyria Catholic pulls away late for 56-42 victory

Roger Negin
The Chronicle-Telegram

PARMA — North Coast League games are often a matter of survival.

Just ask Elyria Catholic.

In a matter of minutes in the fourth quarter the Panthers' relaxation turned into perspiration before they were able to subdue Padua, 56-42, Friday night.

But on paper, it should have been easier for EC.

The Panthers came into the game with a 7-2 record while the Bruins had only one win in 10 games. And in the beginning it did look easy.

The Panthers scored the game's first 14 points and had a 14-2 lead after eight minutes. EC's carelessness — and Padua's aggressive play — made it a game in the second quarter, but the Panthers regained the momentum and led 44-28 with 5:40 left in the game.

Game, set and match, right? Not so fast.

The Bruins, again taking advantage of sloppy EC play, rattled off a 14-point run in a matter of two minutes, 47 seconds, to close to within two points at 44-42.

Then sophomore Joe Bailosky sank a perimeter jump shot to lead a final 12-point Panther run in the last 2:42.

"He'll put them up," said Joe's brother, Jake, who led the Panthers with 18 points. "He doesn't back down to pressure."

"Joey's got ice in his veins," said coach Bob Walsh. "He just plays. He never thinks about two minutes ago, he just plays the next play."

After his basket gave EC a four-point lead, Mike Clapham knocked the ball away from the Bruins and Jake Bailosky sank two free throws. Jason Smith, who had 15 points and six rebounds, canned two more after another of Padua's 25 turnovers.

Then Jake Bailosky had a steal, layup and followed with two more from the line. Zach Stephens finished with a basket in the final 17 seconds.

While the Panthers' response to the final challenge was admirable, Walsh didn't think his team reacted well to Padua's physical play.

"Physically, they took us out of the game," he said. "It just tore up our rhythm and that can't happen. We've got to overcome that.

"If we run our offense and make four, five, six or seven passes, the physical play becomes obvious and they'll call fouls. But when you make only one or two passes, that's not the answer."

"They got a little physical," Jake Bailosky said. "Actually it was a good experience away from home. We've got to play through that."

The Panthers also got away from their height advantage. The 6-foot-7 Smith only had five points in the first half and 6-7 Josh Brenning had only two. The two combined for just seven shots in the first half.

With no inside scoring in the second quarter, Elyria Catholic's offense went stagnant. Padua, helped by sharp free-throw shooting, got to within six, 25-19, at intermission.

EC rediscovered its inside game in the third quarter as Smith and Brenning, who also had 11 rebounds, scored the team's first eight points. A 3-pointer by Jake Bailosky and Stephens' fast break pushed it back to 12 after three quarters.

With 5:40 left in the game, and the Panthers on top by 16, Padua made a strong bid for an upset. Three EC turnovers, one an offensive foul, and three 3-pointers by Padua got it to within two.

Then Joe Bailosky stuck a jump shot that got the Panthers back on track.

"I didn't feel real comfortable," Walsh said. "I expected it to be tight. They're physical and scrappy."

Padua hit just 11 baskets from the floor, but made 14 of 15 from the line.

ELYRIA CATHOLIC (56): Jason Smith 4-7 15, Mike Clapham 2-0-4 Josh Brenning 3-0-6 Jake Bailosky 6-4-18 Joe Bailosky 2-1-6 Eric Escovenier 0-0-0 Joe Gross 0-0-0 Mike Volk 0-0-0 Nes Fentner 0-0-0, Zach Stephens 3-1 7 **Totals 20-13-56.**
PADUA (42): Alex Kocin 1-0-2 John Toth 0-0-0 Dan Quring 0-0-0 Aaron Apathy 2-6-11 Steve Jirga 2 3-7 Matt Jankowsu 5-1-16, Marcus Banks 0-0-0, Josh Janosik 0-0-0 Matt Hunt 1-4-6 **Totals 11-14-42.**

Elyria Catholic	14	11	13	18	—	56
Padua	2	17	7	16	—	42

Three-pointers. Elyria Catholic (3-10) Jake Bailosky 2 Joe Bailosky Padua (6-16) Jankowsu 5 Apathy **Rebounds.** Elyria Catholic 33 (Brenning 11) Padua 23 (Kocin 6) **Turnovers:** Elyria Catholic 19 Padua 25 **Fouls:** Elyria Catholic 16 Padua 19 **Fouled out:** Toth. **Free throws:** Elyria Catholic 13 of 15 (68 percent) Padua 14 of 15 (93 percent) **Field goals.** Elyria Catholic 20 of 46 (43 percent) Padua 11 of 39 (28 percent)

Junior varsity: Elyria Catholic 40-32

Sluggish start sinks Saints

Rahula Strohl
The Chronicle-Telegram

LORAIN — Usually a bad fourth quarter is the killer.

Southview had a big fourth quarter on Friday night, but the Saints couldn't overcome the fact that they didn't score in the first quarter as they lost to Lake Erie League rival Lakewood, 65-55.

"It cost us the game," Southview coach Brian Koury said of the first quarter. "I thought we came out playing tentatively with a high anxiety level.

"More than anything else, the kids knew how big a game this was and the type of team we were playing."

Lakewood (8-2, 4-1 LEL) scored 17 points — 14 in the first quarter — before Donte McGill laid the ball up with 6:57 left in the second quarter to break the shutout.

The Saints (5-6, 2-4) started the game with a full-court press, which got them into foul trouble. Lakewood was in the bonus by the end of the first quarter.

Koury pulled the press and the teams traded baskets for most of the second quarter. But the Rangers built their lead to 20 to start the second half, and Koury put the press back in.

Southview cut the lead to 12 toward the end of the third, and to five in the fourth quarter.

"We went with a smaller, quicker lineup (late in the third quarter) and that's when the pressure started, and I think they got a little tired," Koury said. "It hurt us at half court, but pressing was where we were getting the points."

Gabe Rios stole the ball in the backcourt and laid it in with 3:07 left to make the score 51-44, inducing Lakewood coach Rob Slone to call a timeout. Marquel Miller matched Rios with a steal and layup of his own after the timeout.

But Southview was tagged for a delay of game warning and didn't get closer than seven points the rest of the game.

"We cut it to five by gambling to the passing lane, bringing an extra guy up," Koury said. "All it takes is to get it to half court and you can get that layup."

Lakewood made a layup after the delay call and a defensive stop on Southview's ensuing possession. The Saints then started fouling to stop the clock, and the Rangers made 12 of 14 free throws in the last 2:30 of the game.

John Dillingham, who led all scorers with 28, was 8-for-8 in that stretch — his only free throws of the game.

"It's been one of those years for us, we haven't been really consistent," Slone said. "We play hard at the beginning then coast. You can't do that in the LEL."

It's worked so far for Lakewood, but Slone doesn't expect the luck to last.

"As a coach I'm tired of having the tempo of the game dictated to us rather than us dictating the tempo," he said. "The press gave us a lot of trouble and that irritates me because we've seen the press all year."

Southview travels to Cleveland Heights on Friday, and Lakewood faces St. Edward at the Cleveland State Convocation Center on Sunday.

LAKEWOOD (65) Kidd 3-2-8 Gifford 1-0-2 Fannin 5-6-15 Butts 2-3-7 Dillingham 8-8-28 Fox 2-0-4 **Totals 21-19-65**
SOUTHVIEW (55) Nixon 4-2-10 Miller 6-2 14 Rios 6-3-15 McGill 1-0-2 Brown 2 1 5 Jackson 1 3 5 Joyner 2-0-4 **Totals 22-11-55**

Lakewood	14	15	18	18	—	65
Southview	0	15	16	24	—	55

Three-pointers (L) Dillingham 4 **(S)** none **Turnovers** Lakewood 21 Southview 16 **Fouls** Lakewood 20 Southview 20
Junior varsity Southview 45-33

Shoremen run out of gym

Amherst cruises to easy 61-33 win

Steve Byrne
The Chronicle-Telegram

AVON LAKE — Mitch Gillam had a premonition at halftime, even if he had a tough time explaining why he had it.

"I had a sense we would go on a little run, just from a feeling about the flow of the game," Gillam said. "I can't explain it. It's just getting some sense of which way the game is flowing."

Gillam's premonition came true. The flow of the game between his Amherst team and Avon Lake was definitely going his way. But it wasn't a little run Amherst enjoyed, it was a big one.

The Comets dominated the second half in a 61-33 rout of the Shoremen in a Southwestern Conference game Friday. Amherst outscored Avon Lake 33-11 over the last two periods and 28-6 for the game's final 13 minutes, 55 seconds. The Comets went on a 21-2 run over a 10:33 stretch between the third and fourth quarters.

The victory hikes Amherst's record to 5-5 and 4-2 in the SWC. Avon Lake drops to 1-9 and 0-6 in the conference.

"In actuality we're still in the midst of it," Gillam said about the race for a conference championship. "We got off to a slow start because of adversity, injuries and illnesses. Our confidence was shaken at the beginning. I won't say we have it all solved, but we seem to be getting a little better each time out."

The Comets have won four straight SWC games.

Nick Mihalic scored nine of his team-leading 14 points in the fourth quarter, including seven in a row in a 10-0 run that gave the Comets a 25-point lead at 3:38 to play. Jacob Knipp added 11 points for Amherst, nine in the first half. Wes Immler had six assists.

"We didn't match up well with their quickness," Avon Lake coach Dave Olinger said. "They have a very quick team. We had a hard time handling their guards. We had a hard time with their pressure. It was just a rough night all the way around.

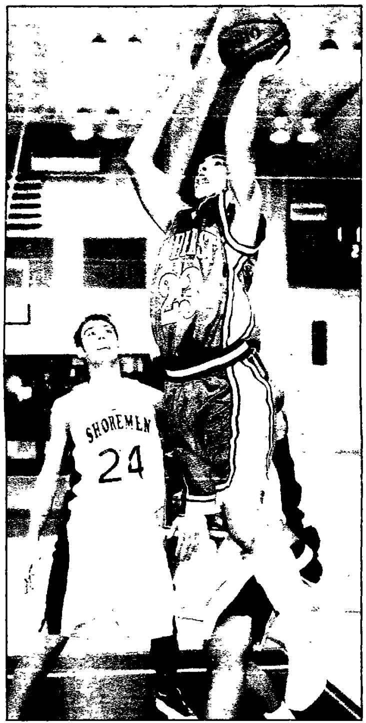
"We were in too much of a hurry to shoot in the second half," Olinger said. "We didn't work the ball to our strength, which is John Homenik."

Homenik, a senior forward, scored only four points. Brian Day led Avon Lake with 13.

A jump shot by Knipp with 6:18 remaining in the first half put Amherst ahead to stay. The Comets led 28-22 at halftime and were still in front by six points when David Briggs of the Shoremen scored at 5:55 of the third period.

Avon Lake went 7:13 before scoring again. The Comets, meanwhile, went on an 11-0 run for a 44-27 lead.

Day ended the drought with a layup at 6:41 of the fourth quarter, but Amherst scored 10 unanswered points over a 2:11 stretch to effectively finish off the Shoremen.



LINDA MURPHY / CHRONICLE

UNCONTESTED: Amherst junior Antoine DeJesus scores two of his eight points in front of Avon Lake senior John Homenik on Friday night.

AMHERST (61): Mihalic 5-2-14, Knipp 5-1-11, Gonzalez 2-0-6, Immler 2-2-6, DeJesus 3-2-8, Nowicki 1-1-3 Canter 3-1-7 Knoll 2-0-4 Mann 0-0-0, Cesear 1-0-2, Brucker 0-0-0 **Totals 24-9-61.**
AVON LAKE (33): Day 5-1-13 St. Clair 1-0-2, Kostelnik 2-0-4 Homenik 2-0-4, Briggs 2-0-4, Justin Resar 1-0-3, Bruce 0-0-0, Gaydosh 1-0-2, Gaydosh 0-0-0, Means 0-1-1 Moorman 0-0-0 Fox 0-0-0, Nate Gamellia 0-0-0 **Totals 14-2-33.**

Amherst	13	15	14	19	—	61
Avon Lake	12	10	5	6	—	33

Three-pointers: Amherst 4 (Mihalic 2, Gonzalez 2), Avon Lake 3 (Day 2, Resar) **Rebounds:** Amherst 18 (Immler 4) Avon Lake 28 (St. Clair 7) **Turnovers:** Amherst 13 Avon Lake 18. **Total fouls:** Amherst 12, Avon Lake 11 **Fouled out:** None
Junior varsity: Avon Lake 46-35

GIRLS ROUNDUP

Keystone rebounds for victory

CUYAHOGA FALLS — Jamie Perin scored a game-high 15 points, all on 3-pointers, to lead Keystone to a 44-42 non-conference win over Walsh Jesuit on Friday night.

Jessica Fraley contributed 11 points for the Wildcats, who had to outscore the Warriors 16-13 in the fourth quarter to erase a 29-28 deficit at the end of the third quarter.

Amanda Terry dropped in a pair of 3-pointers for the Wildcats.

KEYSTONE (44): Bell 1-0-2 Perin 5-0-15 Cyrus 1-0-2, A. Terry 2-0-6, Schaffer 1-2-4, J. Fraley 4-3-11, Dudley 2-0-4 **Totals 15-5-44**
WALSH JESUIT (42): Tausch 3-0-6 Niedenthel 2-0-4 Sweeney 0-1-1, May 1-0-3 Dent 4-2 10 Gregorevich 5-1-12 Dominick 3-0-6 **Totals 18-4-42.**

Keystone	10	8	10	16	—	44
Walsh Jesuit	4	9	16	13	—	42

Three-pointers: (K) Perin 5, A. Terry 2 (WJ) May, Gregorevich
Junior varsity: Walsh Jesuit, 61-16

Lake Ridge 33, Medina Christian 28

NORTH RIDGEVILLE — The Royals (4-4) applied more pressure and dominated the inside in the second half to erase a 14-9 halftime deficit.

Lake Ridge's Morgan Francis led all scorers with 16 points, including 11 in the fourth quarter.

The Royals' 16-point fourth quarter proved to be the difference as they held Medina Christian to eight points in the final eight minutes.

MEDINA CHRISTIAN (28): K. Staph 2-1-5 A. Staph 5-3-13, Young 1-0-2, Benedett 4-0-8 Justice 0-0-0 **Totals 12-4-28.**
LAKE RIDGE (33): Gardner 2-0-6 Whiteman 3-0-6 Francis 7-2-16, DiOrio 1-1 3 Walleck 1-0-2 **Totals 14-3-33.**

Medina Christian	4	10	6	8	—	28
Lake Ridge	3	6	8	16	—	33

Three-pointers: (LR) Gardner 2

Open Door 36, First Baptist 16

ELYRIA — Monica Christofferson and Amanda Rowe each scored 10 points to lead the Patriots (6-2).

Open Door's Ali Miller pulled down 16 rebounds, while Erica Butcher led the Sabres (1-10) with eight points.

The Patriots held First Baptist scoreless in the third quarter and outscored the Sabres 18-5 in the second half.

OPEN DOOR (36): Christofferson 3-4-10, Alaksa 4-1 9 Rowe 5-0-10 Miller 2-3-7 **Totals 14-8-36.**
FIRST BAPTIST (16) Taubler 1-1 3 Rader 1-0-2, White 1-1-3 Butcher 4-0-8 **Totals 7-2-16.**

Open Door	11	7	8	10	—	36
First Baptist	5	6	0	5	—	16

Gansey and Binggeli lead Olmsted Falls to 10-0 start

FAIRVIEW PARK — The unbeaten Bulldogs (10-0, 6-0 SWC) rebounded after trailing by a point at the end of the first quarter by outscoring Fairview 17-6 in the second quarter on the way to an 82-50 shellacking of Fairview on Friday night.

Steve Gansey led Olmsted Falls with 28 points, including four 3-pointers. Dan Binggeli added 25, including 10 free throws, for the Bulldogs.

R.J. Dieringer led three Warriors (5-5, 3-3 SWC) in double figures with his 13 points.

OLMSTED FALLS (82) Mental 1 2-5 Binggeli 7-10-25 Braddick 3-0-7 Scales 4-0-8 Romp 1-0-2 Arcuri 0-3-3 Gansey 10-4 28 Rockhold 1-0-2 Tabar 1-0-2 **Totals 28-19-82.**
FAIRVIEW (50) Dieringer 4-4-13 Rozak 2-0-4 Schuler 2-2-6 Bensie 0-1-1 Stanton 5-0-12 Eaden 5-0-10, Davis 2-0-4 **Totals 20-7-50**

Olmsted Falls	19	17	28	18	—	82
Fairview	20	6	13	11	—	50

Three-pointers: (OF) Mental Binggeli Braddick, Gansey 4 **(F)** Dieringer Stanton 2
Junior varsity Olmsted Falls 56-45

BOYS ROUNDUP

North Olmsted 55, Rocky River 40

ROCKY RIVER — Steve Trapp's game-high 18 points led three Eagles (7-3, 4-2 SWC) in double figures.

Mike Easter (14) and Dave Janis (13) also scored in double figures for North Olmsted.

Brian Clark's 13 points led the Pirates (4-6, 3-3 SWC), who scored in single digits in the first, third and fourth quarters.

NORTH OLMSTED (55): Easter 6-2-14 Janis 5-0-13 Kissel 0-1-1 Mahon 1-0-2 Hagen 1-0-2, Trapp 6-3-18 Connors 1-3-5 **Totals 20-9-55.**
ROCKY RIVER (40): Moore 1-0-2, Clark 4-3-13, English 2-1-6 Wattkus 4-0-9 Pampush 4-0-8, Preston 1-0-2 **Totals 16-4-40.**

North Olmsted	10	16	12	17	—	55
Rocky River	7	15	9	9	—	40

Three-pointers (NO) Janis 3 Trapp 3 **(RR)** Clark 2 English Wattkus
Junior varsity North Olmsted 52-33

Bay 83, Westlake 69

BAY VILLAGE — The Rockets (6-4, 3-3 SWC) led 23-9 after the first quarter as they kept Westlake winless in Southwestern Conference action.

Tyler Trutza scored a game-high 23 points for Bay and was joined in double figures by Kyle Lawrence (16) Matt Phillips (12) and Grant Bordine (10).

Billy Welsh and Mike Tomallo led the Demons (2-9, 0-5 SWC) with 17 points apiece, while Scott Weber contributed 12.

WESTLAKE (69) Zavesky 1-0-2 Welsh 7-0-17, Corrigan 1-1-4 Stricker 1-0-2, Pruitt 3-0-6 Weber 4-0-12 McCallom 3-1 7, Miller 1-0-2, Tomallo 7-3-17
BAY (83) Houlas 0-2-2 Lawrence 6-0-16 Doyle 2-0-4 Bordine 4-2-10 VanBuskirk 1-0-2, Riedel 3-2-9 Trutza 9-2 23 Wenzell 1-0-3, Stavlas 0-2-2 Phillips 6-0-12 **Totals 32-10-83.**

Westlake	9	19	19	22	—	69
Bay	23	18	24	18	—	83

Three-pointers: (W) Welsh 3 Corrigan Weber 4 **(B)** Lawrence 4 Riedel, Trutza 3, Wenzell
Junior varsity: Westlake won

Brooklyn 65, Lutheran West 55

BROOKLYN — The Hurricanes had a 22-5 advantage in free throws as they outscored Lutheran West 38-20 in the second and third quarters.

The game was tied 8-8 after the first quarter before Brooklyn went on the run.

Tyler Minnick and Richard Semrau each scored 14 points for the Longhorns (5-5, 5-2 MAC-8), with Minnick's total including three of Lutheran West's four 3-pointers.

LUTHERAN WEST (55): Schifirk 1-1-3, Ronschke 2 1-5, Minnick 5-1-14, Davila 4-0-9 Miller 3-0-6 Semrau 6-2-14, Nemitz 1-0-2, Spurlock 1-0-2, **Totals 23-5-55.**
BROOKLYN (65): Latimer 3-2-11 Grassi 8-11-27 Neale 2-0-4, Petkac 1-3-5 DeLuca 5-6-16 Stevnacy 1-0-2 **Totals 20-22-65.**

Lutheran West	8	12	8	27	—	55
Brooklyn	8	21	17	19	—	65

Three-pointers: (LW) Minnick 3 Davila **(B)** Latimer 3
Junior varsity: Lutheran West, 78-49

Loudonville 79, Black River 32

SULLIVAN — Unbeatern Loudonville (11-0, 5-0 MAC) had four double-figure scorers and outscored Black River in every quarter in Mohican Area Conference action.

Kyle Clark and Brent Deidrick each had 10 points for the Pirates (3-6, 1-4 MAC).

LOUDONVILLE (79): VanHorn 5-0-11 Davis 5-4-14, Wittel 3-0-7, Humphrey 7-1-15, Spreng 1-0-2, Young 3-3-10, Huffman 2-2-7, Reynolds 3-0-6, Sihzton 1-1-3, Scott 1-0-3, Rooks 0-1-1 **Totals 31-12-79.**
BLACK RIVER (32): Plank 1-0-2, Clark 5-0-10, Volcansek 1-0-2, Deidrick 4-2-10, Riffle 1-0-2, Scarbrough 3-0-6 **Totals 15-2-32.**

Loudonville	20	22	19	18	—	79
Black River	9	5	12	6	—	32

Three-pointers: (L) VanHorn, Wittel, Young, Huffman, Scott
Junior varsity: Loudonville 73-29

Mansfield 88, Vermilion 54

VERMILION — The Tygers (9-3, 4-1 OHC) made 57 percent of their field-goal attempts, had four double-figure scorers and outscored Vermilion in every quarter in Ohio Heartland Conference action.

Nick Roniger led the Sailors (3-8, 0-5 OHC) with 17 points, while Brent Dover added 11.

MANSFIELD (88): Carter 2-0-4 Smith 1-0-2, Jones 2-0-5 Mathews 7-3-18, R. Williams 6-5-19, Graves 0-4-4 Corbin 0-2-2 A. Williams 1-2-4 Stallard 0-2-2, Cha-Kur 5 2 12, Christine 2-2-6, Avery 4-2-10 **Totals 30-24-88.**
VERMILION (54): Allsop 1-0-3 Dover 3-4-11 Allen 3-2-8, Roniger 6-4-17, Uligren 1-0-2, Colatruglio 2-0-4, Deeson 2-5-9 **Totals 18-15-54**

Mansfield	21	19	26	22	—	88
Vermilion	8	13	15	18	—	54

Three-pointers: (M) Jones, Mathews R. Williams 2 (V) Allsop, Dover Roniger
Junior varsity: Mansfield 65-26

North Royalton 51, Midpark 43

NORTH ROYALTON — The Bears (9-2, 6-1 PC) led 34-21 after three quarters but had to withstand being outscored 22-17 in the fourth quarter in Pioneer Conference action.

The Meteors fell to 1-6 in PC action and 2-9 overall.

MIDPARK (43): Eaton 2-3-8 Petkac 1-2-4 Santiago 3-3-12, Gardner 0-3-3, Zeszotek 4-8-16 **Totals 10-19-43**
NORTH ROYALTON (51): Sevchek 5-0-13, Kukla 4-0-10 Guilfoyle 0-2-2 Lyon 2-2-7 Prokopovich 0-1-1, Legersko 1-0-2 Mastrodonato 2-0-4 Friscone 5 1-12 **Totals 19-8-51.**

Midpark	9	4	8	22	—	43
North Royalton	13	9	12	17	—	51

Three-pointers: (M) Eaton Santiago 3 **(NR)** Sevchek 3, Kukla 2
Junior varsity: North Royalton 58-34

Open Door 70, First Baptist 12

ELYRIA — Tori Davis' game-high 16 points for the Patriots (6-3, 3-0 NSAC) were more than First Baptist's boys were able to score in North Shore Athletic Conference action.

Steve Anderson led the Sabres (2-8, 0-4 NSAC) with four points.

OPEN DOOR (70): Madalone 3-2-8 Schmidt 1-1-3, Asbury 3-2-8 Piper 3-2-8, Herron 1-0-2 Freeman 4-0-8 Davis 7-2-16 Kovach 3-0-6 Mason 4-1-9, A. Bien 1-0-2 **Totals 30-10-70.**
FIRST BAPTIST (12): Reaser 1-0-2, Berghaus 1-0-2, Park 1-0-2 Anderson 2-0-4, Parker 1-0-2 **Totals 6-0-12.**

Open Door	22	16	19	13	—	70
First Baptist	2	6	0	4	—	12

Junior varsity: First Baptist 51-46 (2OT)